



Weekly Insights | Oct 23, 2025

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Executive Summary

Corn – Futures Stable, Dec/Mar Carry Narrows on Export Pull

December corn settled at \$4.36/bu, up 2¢ from \$4.34 last week, as basis strength and solid inspections balanced remaining harvest pressure. The Dec/Mar spread narrowed slightly to 14.5¢ (72 percent of full carry), reflecting firm nearby demand from Gulf exporters and ethanol producers. CIF Gulf bids rose another two cents amid limited barge availability, and inspections for the week ended Nov 7 reached 1.42 MMT (–17 percent w/w), and 76 percent above last year level. The average analysts WASDE preview points to unchanged U.S. production but minor upward

revisions to export demand (+75 mbu median estimate), lifting the 2025/26 export projection to 2.300 billion bushels.

Wheat – Board Gains Continue, Russian Offers Steady But Tightening

December SRW wheat settled at \$5.34/bu, down 19¢ from \$5.53 last week but still holding a portion of the recent three-week rebound as Plains dryness persisted and speculative shorts trimmed exposure. The Dec/Mar spread narrowed to 14.5¢ (72 percent of carry), while FOB Russia offers moved up \$2/MT and U.S. HRW premiums held firm. Weekly inspections were 290k mt (down 17 percent week on week), with Indonesia and Mexico the top destinations. Analysts WASDE consensus sees little change to U.S. S&D but a modest bump in Russian export estimates and tighter Argentine production outlook.

Soybeans – Futures Edge Higher on Verbal Framework Chatter, Gulf Basis Diverges

January soybeans rose 8¢ to \$11.32/bu (about +0.7 percent), supported by market chatter about a U.S.–China verbal purchase framework, though soybeans were not included in China's tariff rollback and no confirmed U.S. purchases have been reported. CIF bids were flat to two cents softer w/w as barge freight in the Lower Miss rebounded, while processor bids in the East remained steady to firm. The Jan/Mar spread widened to 14¢ (72 percent of full carry), consistent with steady crush margins despite subdued export pull. Export inspections dipped to 1.09 MMT, up from 0.984 last week. Reuters expects USDA to hold production and crush unchanged in the Nov WASDE, with a wide range of views on Chinese imports (98–105 MMT).

(Carry % calculated assuming 7% annual interest and \$0.05/bu per month storage/insurance cost over the spread interval.)

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info@HigbyBarrett.com

Macro/Policy – Crude Weakens, Dollar Flat, China Tariff Cuts Drive Sentiment

Crude oil eased to around \$59/bbl (down roughly four percent w/w), weighing on biofuel margins but offering freight relief. The U.S. Dollar Index held at 99.6, while the BRL slipped slightly to 5.27 and the ARS drifted to 1,410 officials. Markets absorbed China's Nov 10 tariff suspension on U.S. corn and wheat (soybeans remain under a 10–13 percent duty) and unconfirmed reports of a verbal framework for 12 MMT of late-2025 U.S. soybean purchases, which has not yet shown up in USDA daily sales.

Weather – U.S. Harvest Wraps, Central Brazil Sees Patchy Relief

Harvest was effectively complete as of Nov 10, with corn near 92 percent and soybeans near 96 percent finished. Southern barge routes reopened with improved flow in the Lower Mississippi, but persistent dryness remains in central Mato Grosso and Goiás. Rains early in the week improved seeding pace, but deeper soil moisture deficits linger. In Argentina, cooler, dry weather aided corn planting and preserved subsoil reserves, while wheat entered fall under mostly favorable conditions.

What's Next (Nov 13 – Nov 19):

WASDE (Nov 14): Watch for any yield revisions or China import shifts. Reuters median estimates show steady corn/soy production but potential +75 mbu corn exports and slightly lower soybean ending stocks.

River Freight Trends: Monitor Cairo–Memphis freight index after recent barge draft improvements; further relief could lift CIF basis.

Brazil Rainfall Outlook: Any confirmation of a dry bias through Nov 20 could accelerate speculative soy and meal buying.

Export Sales Catch-Up: USDA's backlog of sales data may reveal stronger soy activity in early November, key for detecting any shift in China's forward purchase behavior.

Ethanol Margins: With crude slipping, next EIA data (Nov 13) will indicate if weekly run rates remain above 1.123 mbpd.

China Buying Pace: Given the unconfirmed verbal framework, any actual purchase volume or shipment timing (Q4 vs Q1) will be crucial for basis and board strength.

Table A – CME Futures (Front Contracts)

(Prices in USD per bushel, volume/open interest in contracts)

Contract (Front Month)	11/05/2025 Close	11/12/2025 Close	Change (Δ)	Δ%	5-day Realized Vol* (x)	Open Interest Δ (x)
Corn (Dec '25)	\$4.34	\$4.36	+\$0.02	+%0.46	13% (ann.)	-28k (est.)
Soybeans (Jan '25)	\$11.24	\$11.32	+\$0.08	+%0.71	12% (ann.)	+7k (est.)
Wheat (Dec '25)	\$5.53	\$5.34	-\$0.19	-%3.44	20% (ann.)	-4k (est.)

5-day realized volatility estimated from daily settlement price changes.

Actual contract open interest changes are estimated; total corn OI rose slightly as new-crop hedges built, while wheat OI fell with Sep contract deliveries.

Table B – Key Calendar Spreads & % of Full Carry

Spread (Crop '25→'26)	11/05 Quote	11/12 Quote	Δ (carry)	% Full Carry*	Market Implication
Corn Dec–Mar	-\$0.14	-\$0.14	+0.00	72%	Nearby Gulf demand firming vs. interior harvest flow

Soy Jan–Mar	-\$0.11	-\$0.14	-0.03	72%	Crush pull holding January, export sales still Brazil-facing
Wheat Dec–Mar	-\$0.13	-\$0.14	-0.01	72%	Plains dryness supporting spreads, but Black Sea competition wide

Assumes 7% annual interest + \$0.05/bu/month storage/insurance. Full carry (3 months) ≈ \$0.22–\$0.23 for corn & SRW wheat; (2 months) ≈ \$0.22 for soybeans. % of full carry = (calendar spread ÷ calculated full carry).

Table C – Notable International Futures (weekly moves, if significant):

Exchange (Front Month)	11/05 USD Price	11/12 USD Price	Δ%	Notes
Dalian Corn (Jan)	¥2,141(\$6.40/bu)	¥2,151(\$6.46/bu)	+0.5%	China corn futures held firm on steady feed demand; domestic prices remain well above import parity even after tariff rollback.
Dalian Soymeal (Jan)	¥3,100 (\$11.84/mt)	¥3,046 (\$11.67/mt)	-1.7%	Soymeal eased on sluggish hog margins, with steady inclusion rates but subdued feed demand.
B3 (São Paulo) Corn (Nov)	R\$64.68 (\$11.85)	R\$64.20 (\$11.75)	-0.7%	Brazilian corn softened slightly on steady domestic logistics and competitive U.S. Gulf offers into MENA and Asia.
Euronext Wheat (Dec)	€194 (\$221.46 mt)	€196 (\$223/mt)	+0.8%	EU wheat held steady amid ample stocks; slight firmness capped by cheap Black Sea offers.

Corn Market Deep Dive

Pre-WASDE Positioning: The trade enters Friday's WASDE expecting minimal change to U.S. corn supply but modest strength on the demand side. According to the Reuters poll conducted through November 10–12, the average analyst forecast holds yield at 183.5 bu/acre and production at 15.557 billion bushels. Ending stocks are seen near 2.100 billion bushels, with the key expected change being a +75 mbu increase in exports to 2.300 billion, justified by strong inspections and firm Gulf basis. Ethanol use is projected flat at 5.4 billion bushels, with no consensus for feed or residual adjustments. On the global side, trade looks for Russia's crop at 59 MMT, Argentina around 52 MMT, Brazil at 132.8 MMT, and China's imports near 7 MMT. If realized, the report would validate stronger front-end demand and justify Dec/Mar firmness, though futures may need actual Chinese demand or South American weather stress to extend higher. Market tone remains balanced, not bearish, but lacking a fresh bullish trigger

Futures & Spreads: December corn settled at \$4.36/bu, up two cents from \$4.34 last week, as basis strength and solid Gulf pull offset harvest-weighted flows.. The Dec/Mar spread narrowed to 14.5¢ (72 percent of full carry), its tightest since September, signaling stronger nearby demand. Five-day realized volatility held near 13 percent annualized with flat skew, leaving the price tone steady but underpinned.

Funds & Positioning: No official CFTC data have been published due to the federal shutdown. Private estimates indicate managed money net short roughly –94 k contracts, a 15k reduction from the prior period, consistent with light short-covering ahead of the WASDE.

U.S. Cash & Basis: CIF basis climbed to +94¢ over Dec, up two w/w, with active loadings to Mexico and Central America. Illinois River basis improved to –20¢ under, while Lower Mississippi firmed to –42¢ to –45¢ under as river levels rose to about –7 ft at Memphis, easing barge congestion. Ethanol plants across

the western Corn Belt held firm at +15¢ to +20¢ over, supported by solid margins and run rates near 1.123 mbpd. The national average basis stood around –38¢ under, unchanged on the week.

Export Flows: FGIS reported inspections of 1.42 MMT for the week ending Nov 7, down 17 percent w/w from 1.669 MMT, yet still 76 percent above the same week last year. Gulf loadings led, with Mexico, Colombia, and South Korea the top destinations. U.S. FOB Gulf offers were about \$210/MT (\$5.27/bu), roughly \$10/MT above Brazilian offers into Asia. No flash sales were confirmed, though private chatter pointed to new bookings near 1.0 MMT.

International Trade: Brazil FOB Santos corn stood around \$210/MT (\$5.30/bu), maintaining a freight-adjusted edge into Asia. November exports are pacing near 6.04 MMT, slightly below October but still strong seasonally. Mato Grosso interior prices hovered around BRL 48/sc. Argentina's Up-River FOB was \$205/MT (\$5.17/bu) amid firm EU/MENA demand, while Rosario corn planting was 40 percent complete as of Nov 9. Dalian January corn futures traded near ¥2,200/MT (\$6.62/bu), keeping Chinese domestic prices well above import parity. Although U.S. corn regained tariff-free access, no new Chinese bookings had been confirmed by Nov 12.

So What? The corn market shows subtle strength beneath the surface: spreads firmed, CIF basis improved, and Gulf flows stayed active even as futures held flat. Managed money trimmed shorts, ethanol demand remained steady around 1.123 mbpd, and export inspections, while lower w/w, still outperformed last year. If the WASDE confirms the expected export lift and Brazil's weather stays erratic, December futures could test \$4.38–\$4.43. Until then, spreads and basis remain the clearest indicators of front-end firmness.

Soybean Market Deep Dive

Pre-WASDE Positioning: The trade expects few changes to the U.S. soybean balance sheet in the Nov 14 WASDE. Reuters' survey shows the average yield estimate at 53.0 bu/acre (unchanged from October), keeping production at 4.300 billion bushels. Analysts see 2025/26 ending stocks at 304 million bushels, with no change to crush (2.400 billion) or exports (1.800 billion) in most forecasts. The range of estimates is narrow and reflects little pressure for adjustment without new China sales or a major yield revision. Globally, Brazil's crop is expected to stay near 165 MMT despite early-season dryness, while Argentina's 50 MMT outlook may come under scrutiny in future reports. China's import forecast is expected to hold near 100 MMT. The market bias is neutral to slightly supportive, with few catalysts unless USDA surprises on exports or if traders front-run dryness in Mato Grosso.

Futures & Spreads: January 2026 soybeans closed at \$11.32/bu, gaining 8¢ on the week after posting a one-year high the prior Friday. The Jan/Mar spread widened to 14¢ carry, equal to 72 percent of full commercial carry (6 percent interest, \$0.05/bu/month), reflecting a well-supplied front end with active crushers but soft export pull. Trade volume stayed steady, and volatility remained contained, suggesting commercial buying rather than fund re-entry.

Products & Crush: Board crush margins remained positive with processors still favored by strong meal basis and seasonal oil yield improvements. Soybean oil traded near 50.6¢/lb, tracking weaker crude oil, while soymeal prices hovered around \$322/short ton. Gross crush margins stayed above seasonal averages. NOPA's official October report was not released within the window, but private estimates pegged crush above 200 mbu, up roughly 5 percent from last year.

Funds & Positioning: CFTC data remain unavailable due to the shutdown, but private positioning estimates show managed money net long around 30k contracts, up roughly 8k w/w, as traders added light longs on China tariff optimism and Brazilian weather risk. CME open interest increased modestly, with most growth concentrated in the Jan/Mar spread. The curve remains well-behaved, with no inversion

or nearby tightness.

Cash & Basis: Processor bids in the Eastern Corn Belt held firm between +70¢ to +80¢ over Jan, supported by strong soymeal offtake. Gulf CIF basis eased to +80¢ over, with barge traffic improving but Chinese demand still subdued. Interior river bids improved 3¢ where freight normalized, particularly along the Ohio and Lower Mississippi corridors. National basis averaged near -76¢ under Jan, little changed on the week.

Trade Flows & International Competition: USDA reported soybean inspections at 1.09 MMT for the week ending Nov 7, the lowest in five weeks and about 42 percent below last year's comparable period. Brazil shipped over 7.3 MMT in October and remained the primary supplier to China. FOB Santos was near \$480/MT (\$10.92/bu equivalent), undercutting the U.S. Gulf by about \$8/MT. Chinese crushers booked December and March Brazilian arrivals, while U.S. flash sales remained absent. Argentina's soy flows were limited, with local crushers capturing most domestic supply.

Policy Context: China's Nov 10 tariff rollback did not include soybeans, which remain subject to the 13 percent MFN duty. Trade sources cited an unconfirmed verbal framework discussed by officials for up to 12 MMT in late-2025 purchases and annual targets near 25 MMT through 2028, but no formal confirmation or USDA daily sales followed. Traders remain cautious, treating the framework as intent rather than execution.

So What? The board is supported by crush, not exports. Basis is stable, spreads show no front-end squeeze, and the Jan/Mar carry widened modestly. Without confirmed Chinese purchases or fresh weather deterioration in Brazil, the complex likely stays rangebound in the \$11.13-\$11.33 zone. Until then, structure continues to favor crushers and steady ownership rather than rallies.

Wheat Market Deep Dive

Pre-WASDE Positioning: Traders expect little change to the U.S. wheat balance sheet in the Nov 14 WASDE. Reuters' survey shows analysts forecasting ending stocks near 862 million bushels (USDA Oct: 844), with no adjustments expected to production or demand lines. HRW planting progress and dryness remain background risks but are unlikely to prompt supply-side revisions of this cycle. Globally, Pre-WASDE polls point to slightly higher Russian and Argentine wheat crops versus USDA October, though most expect USDA to move gradually rather than fully matching private estimates. No changes are anticipated for EU or Australia. World ending stocks are forecast at 266 MMT (Oct: 269), indicating a flat tone. Trade attention remains centered on Black Sea logistics and Southern Hemisphere weather, not U.S. shifts.

Futures & Spreads: December SRW futures fell 19¢ on the week to \$5.34/bu, pulling back after a three-week recovery driven by fund short covering and ongoing Plains dryness. The Dec/Mar spread narrowed to 14.5¢ carry (72 percent of full commercial carry), its tightest since early October, signaling that despite the futures setback, the curve remains supported by storage economics. KC HRW December eased three cents to \$5.19/bu, while Minneapolis HRS slipped 2.2¢ to \$5.69/bu. Volatility stayed near 20 percent and open interest was steady, reinforcing that the move was largely technical rather than fundamentally driven.

Global Supply & Demand: Russian 12.5 percent FOB offers firmed \$3/MT to 232/MT, reflecting seasonal tax adjustments and steady ruble support. Russia remained dominant in GASC and Turkish tenders, undercutting U.S. and French offers. French FOB (Rouen) held near \$225/MT, with EU export pace steady. Argentina's crop was still seen near 16 MMT, though field surveys suggest possible reductions ahead. In Australia, late rain improved East Coast harvest quality, but WA yields are confirmed lower. U.S. HRW planting reached 95 percent as of Nov 10, with emergence at 76 percent; 52 percent

rated good to excellent. Dryness lingered in western Kansas and Oklahoma, supporting HRW premiums and calendar spreads.

Cash & Basis: U.S. FOB SRW Gulf offers held near \$225/MT (\$6.70/bu), about \$15/MT over Black Sea comps. HRW FOB values near \$240/MT reflected protein premiums but stayed noncompetitive globally. Domestic mill basis in the southern Plains slipped 1–2¢ w/w, with December coverage mostly complete. Interior bids in Kansas and Nebraska remained weak at –48¢ to –53¢ under, consistent with full-carry hedging and slow demand. The HRW premium to SRW widened modestly on limited high-protein availability.

Trade Flows: FGIS inspections reached 290k tonnes for the week ended Nov 7, down 7.5 percent from the prior week but still well below average. Gulf activity rebounded, led by cargoes to Mexico and the Caribbean. Russian and Ukrainian exports stayed strong via Black Sea and Danube routes, keeping pressure on U.S. competitiveness. No U.S. flash sales were reported, and USDA export sales data was still delayed.

Speculative Positioning: No official CFTC data were released due to the ongoing federal shutdown. Market participants relied on private estimates, which indicated only modest position changes, consistent with the week's technically driven price action rather than any significant shift in speculative appetite.

So What? U.S. wheat strength remains a function of short covering and dryness headlines, not export competitiveness. Spreads still reward storage, and cash premiums reflect protein sorting, not tight supply. Unless Russia restricts flow, Argentina cuts hard, or the dollar weakens materially, Chicago futures likely stay rangebound. The market is firming but not tightening.

U.S. Cash Market & Basis

Corn: River basis improved again this week as water levels in the Lower Mississippi held firm, keeping freight costs below recent highs. Illinois River bids strengthened to –20¢ under December, up two cents w/w, while the Lower Miss firmed to –42¢ to –45¢ under amid normalized drafts and steady traffic. Spot freight from Cairo to Memphis held near \$19.53/ton, flat to slightly firmer depending on timing. CIF Gulf basis rose to +94¢ over December, up two cents, supported by active loadings and strong Mexican demand. Processor bids in Iowa and Nebraska remained stable at +15¢ to +20¢ over, tracking firm ethanol margins. National average corn basis was near –38¢ under, roughly unchanged on the week.

Soybeans: River basis improved again this week as water levels in the Lower Mississippi held firm, keeping freight costs below recent highs. Illinois River bids strengthened to –20¢ under December, up two cents w/w, while the Lower Miss firmed to –42¢ to –45¢ under amid normalized drafts and steady traffic. Spot freight from Cairo to Memphis held near \$19.53/ton, flat to slightly firmer depending on timing. CIF Gulf basis rose to +94¢ over December, up two cents, supported by active loadings and strong Mexican demand. Processor bids in Iowa and Nebraska remained stable at +15¢ to +20¢ over, tracking firm ethanol margins. National average corn basis was near –38¢ under, roughly unchanged on the week.

Wheat: HRW and SRW FOB values held flat near \$240/MT and \$225/MT, respectively, but Gulf export basis softened by 1–2¢ on quiet demand. Interior bids in Kansas and Oklahoma stayed soft at –48¢ to –53¢ under, driven by carry incentives rather than consumption. Southern Plains milling basis slipped slightly as December coverage remained in place. Domestic demand from flour buyers was stable but showed little new spot interest, keeping interior values defensive.

So What? Logistics steadied as river levels normalized, allowing CIF basis to recover and barge freight to

ease off highs. Gulf exporters benefited from improved flow but still face global price headwinds, while processors remained the anchor of cash demand. Basis strength in corn and soy suggests demand is holding pace with post-harvest pressure. Without confirmation of large export programs, particularly to China, processors will continue to set the tone for nearby cash strength.

International Cash & Trade Flows

Brazil: Brazil remained the dominant global supplier of both corn and soybeans, though early November loadings showed a modest slowdown from October's peak. ANEC pegged November soybean exports near 4.26 MMT so far, with corn pacing close to 6.04 MMT, both strong, but slightly off prior-month records. FOB Santos soybean offers held near \$480/MT (\$10.92/bu), maintaining a \$8/MT advantage over U.S. Gulf equivalents into China. Corn FOB values stayed firm around \$210/MT (\$5.30/bu), making Brazil the cheapest origin into Southeast Asia. Interior soybean planting reached 55 percent complete in Mato Grosso as of Nov 10, aided by scattered rainfall, though subsoil moisture deficits remain across parts of Goiás and Tocantins. Export corridors at Paranaguá and Santos operated smoothly, with no reported congestion.

Argentina: Up-River FOB prices were steady to slightly lower: corn offered around \$205/MT and soymeal near \$420/MT. Farmer sales slowed again post-tax incentive window and ahead of the Nov 24 election. The Rosario Exchange kept its corn planting estimate at 40 percent complete, above average, and reaffirmed a 52 MMT production outlook assuming neutral-to-wet summer weather. The unofficial peso rate weakened to 1,410/USD, sustaining local selling pressure despite macro uncertainty. Wheat harvest began in the north under dry but manageable conditions, with crop expectations still ranging from 22–23 MMT. Crushers operated at steady pace using stocks accumulated during September's soy "dollar" window.

China: Import activity remained Brazil-centric. Gulf soybean offers near +\$2.20/bu over Jan futures remained uncompetitive relative to Brazilian cargoes (\$2.10 equivalent), keeping Chinese bookings pointed south. Crushers covered December and early Q1 via Brazilian arrivals, while no confirmed U.S. soybean purchases were registered through Nov 12, and no flash sales were reported. China's Nov 10 suspension of retaliatory tariffs on U.S. corn and wheat (soybeans unchanged at 13% MFN duty), and Dalian Jan corn futures rose to ¥2,151/MT (\$6.46/bu equivalent), still well above landed import parity. Market chatter about long-term Chinese soybean commitments (12 MMT in 2025 and 25+ MMT through 2028) persisted, but without official backing the trade treated these as guidance rather than confirmed demand.

EU / Black Sea: Russian FOB wheat offers for 12.5 percent protein rose to \$232/MT, up \$2–3/MT w/w, as export taxes reset higher. Despite the bump, Russian exporters continued to win major tenders in Egypt and the Middle East. French wheat near \$225/MT (Rouen) remained sidelined after recent Maghreb tenders favored Black Sea sellers. Ukraine maintained steady corn flow through Danube and rail with offers near \$207/MT into Spain and Italy. EU internal grain availability improved as corn and feed wheat harvests wrapped, limiting fresh import interest. Russian and Ukrainian soymeal continued to displace U.S. product into southern Europe, helped by lower freight and FX tailwinds.

Other Origins: No material changes reported in Canada or South Africa. Canada's spring wheat exports flowed at a steady pace, mostly to Mexico and East Asia. Australia's harvest expanded across Queensland and New South Wales, with early results showing improved protein content but mixed yield

recovery after a dry winter. India remained inactive in global grain trade, with no export policy shifts announced.

So What? U.S. exporters remain disadvantaged into Asia and MENA as Brazil and Russia maintain price leadership. China's reluctance to shift from Brazilian beans, even post-tariff rollback, limits Gulf traction. Argentina's political timeline introduces uncertainty, but not enough to alter flow. Until FOB spreads compress or tariff dynamics shift, U.S. cash strength will rely on domestic demand and CIF rather than international arbitrage.

Key Fundamentals & Reports (Nov 6 – Nov 12)

Government Data & Reporting: Federal operations remained paused early in the week, delaying USDA and CFTC data releases amid the extended shutdown. The regular Crop Progress update was not published on Nov 10 due to the Veterans Day schedule, leaving harvest progress to private estimates. WASDE and Crop Production remain on schedule for release Friday, Nov 14, alongside updated CFTC Commitments of Traders through Nov 5. Most private forecasts and trade positions were set in anticipation of that report, limiting new directional inputs.

Crop Progress (estimated as of Nov 2): Industry surveys and state updates suggest U.S. corn harvest near 92 percent complete and soybeans roughly 96 percent, both ahead of five-year averages (81 and 88 percent, respectively). Producers in Illinois, Iowa, and Minnesota are largely finished, with only northern fringes of the Corn Belt still active. Winter wheat planting was effectively complete, with emergence estimated near two-thirds to three-quarters of intended acreage. Dryness persisted in western Kansas and Oklahoma, maintaining slight stress in early HRW stands.

Export Inspections (USDA FGIS – week ending Oct 30, published Nov 3): Corn inspections reached 1.42 MMT (–17 percent w/w), continuing to outpace last year's pace by nearly 76 percent. Soybean inspections fell to 1.09 MMT, the weakest in five weeks, reflecting limited Chinese pull and ongoing competition from Brazil. Wheat loadings totaled 290k tonnes (–7.4 percent w/w), concentrated at the Gulf and PNW but still below seasonal norms. Aggregate flow confirms solid corn performance, subdued soy export pace, and persistently weak wheat competitiveness.

Export Sales (USDA FAS, not published): Weekly sales remained unpublished through Nov 12, though private trackers cited light new soybean sales to "unknown" destinations, likely China, and steady corn commitments to Mexico and Japan. No USDA daily flash sales were reported. Market participants expect catch-up data releases next week, possibly showing backlogged soybean bookings from late October.

Ethanol Production & Stocks (EIA – week ending Oct 31 / published Nov 5): Ethanol output stayed unchanged at 1.123 mbpd. Stocks rose to 22.7 million barrels (+0.3 million w/w), reflecting steady blending and seasonal drawdown. The implied corn grind was around 100 mbu, consistent with firm ethanol margins and processor demand across the Western Corn Belt.

NOPA Crush: No new data were published within the window. Private estimates continued to point toward another historically strong month, with October crush seen above 200 mbu, supported by firm soymeal demand and high board crush margins. Eastern Corn Belt processors maintained strong bids, confirming steady throughput.

CFTC Commitments of Traders: No CFTC reports were released due to the ongoing federal shutdown, leaving the market without official visibility into managed money positioning. Traders relied on private estimates and CME open interest changes, which pointed to only light adjustments across the complex.

Private trackers continued to show corn modestly net short (around -90k contracts) with evidence of minor short-covering, soybeans modestly net long after small additions early in the week, and wheat still heavily net short, though with limited movement in either direction. With no official fund data, market behavior remained driven primarily by physical flow, spreads, basis strength, and pre-WASDE positioning rather than speculative conviction.

So What? Official data flow remains limited, and market direction continues to be driven by physical movement rather than government statistics. Corn fundamentals lean supportive, firm ethanol use, strong CIF, and robust inspections, while soybeans face sluggish exports and reliance on crush margins. Wheat's bounce remains technical, not structural. With Crop Progress absent and WASDE imminent, the next decisive input for traders will be Friday's report and any confirmation of South American weather stress or China buying.

International Reports:

Brazil – ANEC Lineups & Weather Recovery: Early-November ANEC data show Brazil's soybean exports tracking near 4.26 MMT for the month to date and corn at roughly 6.04 MMT, consistent with strong second-crop movement but below October's record pace. FOB Santos soybeans held near \$480/MT (\$10.92/bu), maintaining an \$8/MT discount to U.S. Gulf, while corn offers around \$210/MT (\$5.30/bu) continued to lead global feed grain pricing. Mato Grosso soybean planting advanced to about 55 percent by Nov 10, aided by improved rainfall during the first half of the month, though cumulative soil moisture across central Goiás and Tocantins remains 30 percent below normal. CONAB did not publish a new bulletin within the window, but private sources expect it to trim early-season soybean yield assumptions slightly in its next update. Logistics through BR-163 and ports at Santos and Paranaguá remained fluid, with no reported congestion.

Argentina – BCBA & MAGyP Updates: The Buenos Aires Grain Exchange reported corn planting at 40 percent complete as of Nov 7, ahead of last year's pace, while soy planting reached roughly 10 percent with good moisture in core areas. Wheat harvest advanced in northern provinces, and BCBA maintained national production expectations near 23 MMT. MAGyP's weekly report confirmed continued stability in corn and soybean sowing progress. Up-River FOB corn offers were quoted near \$205/MT, soymeal around \$420/MT, both steady week-on-week. The peso weakened further to roughly 1,410 per USD in parallel markets, sustaining export incentives. Farmer selling slowed ahead of the Nov 24 presidential runoff, with crushers operating on stocks accumulated under September's "soy dollar 5" program.

China – Post-Tariff Adjustment & Import Behavior: Following the Nov 10 suspension of retaliatory tariffs on U.S. corn, wheat, and sorghum, Chinese buyers maintained a cautious stance. No new confirmed U.S. soybean purchases were registered, and crushers continued sourcing primarily from Brazil for December–March arrivals. U.S. Gulf soybeans remained about \$8/MT above Brazilian equivalents on a landed basis. Dalian Jan corn futures settled near ¥2,151/MT (\$6.46/bu eq), soybeans around ¥4,970/MT, and soymeal ¥3,046/MT, all largely stable week-to-week. CNGOIC's early-November feedgrain update noted steady consumption but warned that hog-sector profitability remains low, curbing aggressive feed demand. No new import or reserve announcements were made by MARA or Customs during the period.

Black Sea / EU – Russia Maintains Price Control: Russian 12.5 percent wheat FOB offers increased to \$232/MT (+2 w/w) as the export tax adjusted higher with ruble stability. Despite firmer values, Russia continued to dominate GASC and Turkish tenders. Ukrainian corn offers through Danube ports held near \$207/MT, competitive into southern EU markets. The European Commission's November 7 crop monitor

confirmed good planting progress for 2026 EU winter cereals, with FranceAgriMer rating 68 percent of French wheat good-to-excellent. EU feed grain availability remained comfortable, and Rouen wheat offers stayed near \$225/MT. No major disruptions were reported in logistics across the Black Sea or Danube corridor.

Global – Multilateral Updates: No new AMIS or FAO reports were released during the week. The International Grains Council's latest figures (Oct 31 update) continue to guide sentiment, showing global 2025/26 wheat stocks at 270 MMT, corn at 330 MMT, and soybeans at 410 MMT. Global trade tone remained neutral, with risk concentrated on South American rainfall distribution rather than geopolitical shocks.

So What? Global flows remain anchored by Brazil's corn and soybean dominance and Russia's control of wheat exports. Argentina's planting pace and currency depreciation keep it competitive but add political risk premium ahead of elections. China's post-tariff adjustment has yet to yield meaningful new U.S. buying, leaving Gulf differentials wide. With no new multilateral revisions and freight routes running smoothly, world grain values continue to price off export competition rather than scarcity. The next catalyst rests with Brazil's November rainfall and any follow-through from Chinese demand, both will determine whether the mild firmness in U.S. basis evolves into sustained board support.

Weather & Crop Conditions

United States

Crop Progress & Rainfall: Most harvest activity wrapped up across the Midwest under open skies and warm temperatures. Private estimates place corn harvest around 92 percent complete and soybeans near 96 percent, both ahead of normal pace. Light showers early in the week helped replenish surface moisture in parts of the Ohio and Lower Mississippi Valleys, improving barge draft conditions but having little agronomic effect. In the Plains, winter wheat establishment remains mixed, topsoil moisture deficits persist in western Kansas and Oklahoma, where much of the region received 10-20 mm of precipitation over the past two weeks.

River Levels & Logistics: The Mississippi River system continued to stabilize following late-October rains. Gauge readings at Memphis and Baton Rouge rose modestly, allowing standard barge drafts to resume and freight rates to hold near \$19.53/ton on the Cairo–Memphis route. Traffic flows normalized, but carriers reported that water levels remain below average, keeping transport margins tight and delivery windows sensitive to rainfall patterns.

Temperatures: Temperatures stayed seasonally mild, with daytime highs in the 60s–70s°F across the Corn Belt and low 80s°F in the southern Plains. The continued warmth aided late harvest and natural dry-down but accelerated topsoil moisture depletion in the HRW belt. No frost damage or crop-quality issues were reported.

Outlook (6–10 days): NOAA's Nov 11 outlook projected a drier trend across the central and western Corn Belt, with limited rainfall for Kansas and Nebraska. Higher precipitation probabilities were confined to the lower Mississippi basin and eastern Midwest, suggesting localized river improvement but continued dryness across the Plains. Temperatures are expected to remain above normal, further slowing soil recharge in wheat areas.

South America:

Brazil: Scattered showers returned across the Central-West during the week, improving fieldwork and allowing soybean planting to resume in key producing states. IMEA data show Mato Grosso planting near

55 percent complete as of Nov 10, up sharply from late October. Rains of 20–50 mm fell across Mato Grosso and Goiás, providing some relief but leaving deeper subsoil moisture below seasonal norms. Forecast models from INMET and NOAA indicate additional rain through mid-November, with totals of 40–70 mm expected in central Brazil, enough to sustain planting momentum if verified. Southern states (Paraná, Rio Grande do Sul) stayed mostly dry after heavy October rainfall, with stable conditions favoring early vegetative growth.

Argentina: Weather remained largely favorable following late-October moisture. BCBA reported adequate to optimal soil moisture across most Pampas provinces, with isolated dryness in Córdoba. No significant stress was reported for early corn or newly seeded soybeans. Forecasts call for scattered thunderstorms over central and northern areas delivering 20–35 mm through mid-month. Wheat harvest expanded in northern provinces under benign weather, maintaining good yield potential.

Global: Across the Northern Hemisphere, winter wheat planting progressed steadily. Russia and Ukraine reported normal emergence with stable soil conditions, supported by mild autumn temperatures. In Europe, France, Germany, and Poland all saw adequate rainfall and favorable stand development, with French national public establishment for managing agricultural products rating 68 percent of French wheat good to excellent. Australia's weather pattern remained highly divided, persistent dryness in Western Australia continued to limit yields, while New South Wales and Queensland received scattered showers that improved harvest quality but not overall output. No major anomalies were noted across India, South Africa, or Canada.

So What? Harvest is effectively complete across the U.S., with strong field conditions allowing fast progress and minimal loss. Improved river levels have eased logistical stress, though freight costs remain above normal, tempering basis gains. The key global variable remains Brazil's Central-West rainfall: planting has accelerated, but consistent moisture is still required to stabilize yield expectations. Argentina, Russia, and the EU continue to benefit from stable growing conditions, leaving Brazil's weather trajectory as the decisive factor for short-term oilseed and feedgrain risk pricing.

Synthesis & Outlook

The second week of November marked the first real transition point for the grain complex since early September, as USDA data remained partial amid the ongoing shutdown and the November WASDE approached. After months of trading on basis, inspections, and freight clues, the market now faces the return of official figures that could validate or contradict the story physical markets have been telling. Futures stayed narrow through Wednesday, December corn near \$4.36/bu, January soybeans at \$11.27/bu, and December Chicago wheat around \$5.34/bu, as traders avoided new positions ahead of the release. Spreads stayed firm but orderly, with corn Dec/Mar at 72 percent of full carry, soy Jan/Mar near 72 percent, and wheat Dec/Mar at 72 percent. CIF corn basis pushed higher, processors held firm across soy and ethanol channels, and volatility remained subdued. The market tone was one of calm before confirmation, as traders braced for the first official U.S. balance sheets in nearly two months.

Speculative flows remained minimal, with managed money trimming shorts in corn and wheat and adding modest longs in soybeans. CME open interest rose slightly but continued to show a commercial-led market dominated by hedging and spread roll activity rather than speculative conviction. The return of data restores transparency, but it also resets risk: after relying on anecdotal strength from CIF, crush, and barge freight, the market will once again anchor to measurable fundamentals. If the WASDE confirms resilient U.S. demand, the tone of quiet stability could give way to renewed directional conviction; if not, the calm of recent weeks may be exposed as complacency.

Globally, Brazil continued to dictate price leadership in soybeans and corn, while Russia retained dominance in wheat. Santos soybeans traded near \$480/MT (\$10.92/bu), roughly \$8 below the U.S. Gulf,

and corn FOB values held near \$210/MT. Scattered rains allowed soybean planting in Mato Grosso to accelerate past 55 percent, though subsoil reserves remain thin. Argentina maintained strong field progress, and Russian 12.5 percent wheat offers climbed to \$232/MT without denting export flow. China's tariff suspension on U.S. corn and wheat failed to spur visible buying, and soybeans remain under the 13 percent MFN rate. The global balance therefore stayed heavy, but with weather risks simmering in Brazil and renewed attention on official U.S. data, the market's tone shifted from paralysis to anticipation.

Bullish triggers: The bullish case heading into *WASDE* rests on confirmation of U.S. demand resilience. Strong export inspections, firm CIF basis, and ethanol grind above 1.123 mbpd could justify an upward revision to corn exports, tightening the balance sheet modestly. If soybean crush is revised higher and South American weather falters again, spreads could tighten further, and January futures could push toward the mid-\$11.33s. Wheat would benefit from any sign of constrained Russian logistics or an upward adjustment to Black Sea export taxes, potentially extending the short-covering rally. With funds lightly positioned and volatility compressed, even moderate bullish surprises could trigger an outsized price response.

Bearish triggers: The bearish risk is that *WASDE* reaffirms global abundance and flat domestic demand. If USDA leaves corn exports unchanged, maintains record-high South American production, and fails to lower world stocks, the current carry structures may re-widen. For soybeans, a lack of confirmed Chinese purchases combined with normalized rainfall in Brazil could refocus attention on large global supply and weaken Gulf basis. Wheat remains vulnerable if Russia continues to undercut global tenders, keeping U.S. offers noncompetitive. In that scenario, futures could slip back toward recent range lows, with corn near \$4.26, soybeans around \$11.13, and wheat retracing to the \$5.31s.

Watchlist (Nov 13 – Nov 19):

USDA WASDE (Nov 14): corn export and stocks revisions, global adjustments for Brazil, Argentina, and Russia

Restart of USDA export sales and any catch-up flash reports to “unknown” or China

Brazil rainfall totals in Mato Grosso and Goiás and planting pace through mid-month

Lower Mississippi River barge drafts, freight rates, and CIF follow-through

Russia and Black Sea tender flow, EU export competitiveness, and USD movement

In summary: After two quiet months defined by inferred fundamentals, the return of *WASDE* reintroduces hard data into a market that has grown comfortable trading on sentiment. Corn enters the report with the firmest base, supported by CIF strength and ethanol margins, while soybeans remain crush-driven but capped by Brazil's export edge, and wheat's rally still hinges on technicals and Russian policy. The coming week will determine whether those quiet foundations hold or fracture under new information. For now, the grain complex remains balanced but restless, waiting for confirmation of what the past weeks only suggested.

Ethanol for America Act

The major barrier to a higher Renewable Fuel Standard (RFS) is the fuel versus food debate. Now is the perfect time to move to E15. Corn prices are extremely low, and the latest USDA *WASDE* reported a record crop and a record crop expansion.